

UNA-USA Rules of Procedure

Regular Committee

A complete reference for delegates and the dais covering committee structure, debate mechanics, documentation, and voting procedure.

1. Overview

This document sets out the Rules of Procedure (ROP) governing a UNA-USA-style Regular Committee. It is organized to be read start to finish by delegates new to committee, and used as a quick lookup by everyone else: each concept is defined once, in the section devoted to it, and later sections cross-reference rather than repeat those definitions.

1.1 Roles

The Chair (Executive Board / "the dais") — Moderates debate: recognizes speakers, rules on points and motions, calls and conducts votes, enforces time limits, and ensures proceedings follow the ROP. "Executive Board" (EB) refers to the Chair and any co-chairs or staff running the committee together.

Delegates (Committee Members) — Represent an assigned nation (their portfolio) and are scored across five skill areas — speech delivery, research, Rules of Procedure knowledge, lobbying, and resolution writing — demonstrated through speeches, documents, voting, and lobbying.

Portfolio — The nation a delegate represents for the duration of committee.

1.2 Committee Structure

Committee — The UN organ or subsidiary body serving as the framework for debate. Each committee may adopt specialized rules and has its own powers and expected outputs (e.g., resolutions, press releases).

Agenda — The problem the committee addresses. It is fixed before committee begins but only becomes official once "set" by motion (see § 4.1).

Quorum — The minimum attendance needed for the committee to act — typically one-third of registered delegates, rounded up. Quorum must be met before the committee can move to enter formal debate.

Formal Debate (Formal Session) — The default, structured mode of committee: delegates speak in the order set by the Speaker's List and all procedural actions go through the Chair.

2. Flow of Debate

This section is the roadmap for a committee session; later sections explain each stage in full detail.

2.1 Opening the Committee

Once **quorum** is met, the sequence below brings committee into formal debate:

- Chair calls for points or motions on the floor.
- A delegate moves to enter formal debate; the motion is voted on (simple majority).
- Upon passing, the Chair conducts a roll call in alphabetical order of official portfolio names; each delegate responds "Present" or "Present and Voting" (see § 8.1 for what this choice means).
- Chair again calls for points or motions; a delegate moves to set the agenda, which is voted on (simple majority).
- Chair opens the General Speaker's List (GSL), calling alphabetically for delegates who wish to be added (see § 6).

A delegate's portfolio may appear on any Speaker's List only once at a time; once they have spoken, they may add themselves again.

2.2 The Debate Cycle

After roughly 3–4 GSL speeches (Chair's discretion), the Chair calls for motions, opening a cycle that alternates between moderated caucuses (focused, Chair-supervised discussion of subtopics — § 7) and unmoderated caucuses (free discussion without the Chair — § 8). Committees typically run about 3–4 of each before moving to resolution writing. These counts are guidelines only; the Chair adjusts them for time and debate quality.

2.3 Resolution Phase

A long unmoderated caucus is allocated for drafting Draft Resolutions (DRs). Once blocs submit DRs, the Chair typically accepts 2–3 for presentation. Each is introduced, presented by its authors, and opened to delegate questions, followed by any friendly or unfriendly amendments (§ 10.5).

2.4 Voting and Closing

Each accepted resolution is voted on individually, in presentation order, through up to three rounds (§ 11.3). As soon as one resolution passes by simple majority, voting stops and the remaining resolutions are not voted on. Whether or not any resolution passes, formal debate is then suspended and the committee is adjourned.

3. Roll Call and Voting Status

Roll call happens once, immediately after the motion to enter formal debate passes (§ 2.1). At this stage each delegate chooses a voting status that governs their options for the rest of committee.

Status	Meaning	Can Abstain on Documents?
Present	Retains full flexibility on future votes	Yes — may vote Yes, No, or Abstain
Present and Voting	Commits to taking a position on every vote	No — must vote Yes or No

Choosing **Present** gives a delegate more freedom later; choosing **Present and Voting** signals confidence in the portfolio's stance to the Chair. Once selected, a delegate's status generally holds for the rest of committee.

4. Points

A point is a formal question, clarification, personal request, or concern about ROP implementation or a factual inaccuracy, raised by a delegate to the Chair.

"The Delegate of [portfolio] would like to raise a point of [point type] regarding [concern]."

4.1 Types of Points

Point of Personal Privilege — A personal request to the Chair — e.g., asking to be moved on the Speaker's List due to technical difficulties, or asking the Chair to speak up. May be raised even during another delegate's speech, if it concerns audibility or comfort.

Point of Order — Raised when the ROP is not being followed: motions taken out of order, a procedural or factual error by the Chair or a delegate, use of personal pronouns, etc. Must wait until the end of the delegate's speech in question.

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry — A question to the dais about how the ROP works — order of motions, what a term means, or any other procedural question.

Point of Information — A question posed to another delegate about the content of their speech. By default only usable after GSL speeches, not after moderated caucus speeches, unless the ROP has been amended to allow it (see § 7.6).

4.2 When Points May Be Raised

- Point of Personal Privilege — any time, including mid-speech.
- Point of Order — only at the end of the relevant speech.
- Point of Parliamentary Inquiry and Point of Information — only when the Chair asks, "Are there any points or motions on the floor?"

5. Motions

A motion is a formal request to the Chair about the flow of debate. Unless noted otherwise, all motions are raised when the Chair asks, "Are there any points or motions on the floor?" The list below covers the motions delegates use most; a delegate may bring any other substantive or procedural request to the Chair in the same way.

1. Enter Formal Debate

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to enter formal debate."

Purpose: Transitions the committee into structured debate governed by a Speaker's List.

Vote required: Simple majority

2. Set the Agenda

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to set the agenda to [topic]."

Purpose: Officially names the agenda for deliberation.

Vote required: Simple majority

3. Suspend Debate for an Unmoderated Caucus

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to suspend formal debate and enter an unmoderated caucus of [time] minutes for the purpose of [reason]."

Purpose: Lets delegates confer freely without the Chair present; no points are awarded during this time.

Vote required: Simple majority

4. Enter a Moderated Caucus

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to enter a moderated caucus for [total time] minutes with [number] speakers, each speaking for [time] seconds, on the topic of [subtopic]."

Purpose: Opens focused, optional discussion of a subtopic with a fixed Speaker's List.

Vote required: Simple majority

5. Introduce a Draft Resolution

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to introduce Draft Resolution [number/letter]."

Purpose: Presents a completed DR to committee for questions, amendments, and voting.

Vote required: Simple majority (to accept for presentation, at Chair's discretion)

6. Amend the Rules of Procedure

| *"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to amend the Rules of Procedure to [change]."*

Purpose: Proposes a change to the standing ROP.

Vote required: Simple majority

7. Introduce a Friendly Amendment

| *"...moves to introduce a friendly amendment to Draft Resolution [number], [describe change]."*

Purpose: Proposes a minor change to a DR that all authors accept.

Vote required: None — implemented on unanimous author approval

8. Introduce an Unfriendly Amendment

| *"...moves to introduce an unfriendly amendment to Draft Resolution [number], [describe change]."*

Purpose: Proposes a clause addition or change the authors do not approve.

Vote required: Simple majority

9. Close Debate (Move to Previous Question)

| *"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to close debate and move to voting procedure."*

Purpose: Ends debate and proceeds directly to voting.

Vote required: Special majority (2/3)

10. Adjourn the Session

| *"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to adjourn the session."*

Purpose: Permanently ends the committee session.

Vote required: Special majority (2/3)

11. Recess

| *"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to recess for [duration / until HH:MM]."*

Purpose: Temporarily suspends the formal session.

Vote required: Simple majority

12. Reconsider

| *"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to reconsider [prior motion or resolution]."*

Purpose: Reopens a matter already decided for a new vote.

Vote required: Special majority (2/3)

13. Extend Speaking Time

| *"...moves to amend the Rules of Procedure and extend the maximum speaking time for [speech type] to [new time]."*

Purpose: Adjusts a standard speaking-time limit (GSL or moderated caucus cap).

Vote required: Simple majority

5.1 A Note on Table Debate

Some committees also recognize a motion to Table Debate, which pauses discussion of the current agenda item to take up something else, without ending committee. It is treated as moderately disruptive (§ 9.4) and, like other non-listed motions, may be raised at the Chair's discretion under committee-specific rules.

6. The General Speaker's List (GSL)

The GSL is the committee's primary and continuous speaking forum, giving every delegate an equal chance to address the committee on the agenda. It opens automatically upon entering formal debate and remains open — refilled as needed — for the rest of committee. At least one GSL speech must occur between any two caucuses (moderated or unmoderated).

6.1 Adding Yourself to the GSL

The Chair opens the list by calling alphabetically through portfolios:

"Are there any delegates who wish to be added to the General Speaker's List? We will proceed in alphabetical order."

Delegates respond in turn with:

- "The Delegate of [portfolio] would like to be added to the General Speaker's List," or
- "The Delegate of [portfolio] would not like to be added to the General Speaker's List."

After the initial call, a delegate may add themselves at any later point when the Chair asks, "Are there any points or motions on the floor?", using the same script. Requests are processed in the order received. A portfolio may appear only once on the GSL at a time, but there is no limit on how many times a delegate may speak over the course of committee — once their name has passed, they may re-add themselves.

6.2 Speaking Time

GSL speeches have a 90-second upper limit by default, changeable only by a motion to amend the ROP (§ 5, Motion 13). A delegate may yield before using the full time if they finish early.

6.3 Delivering a Speech

When a delegate's name comes up, the Chair recognizes them:

"The Delegate of [portfolio], you have been recognized. You have 90 seconds."

A typical speech: opens by addressing the committee (e.g., "Honorable Chair, fellow delegates"), states the portfolio's position on the agenda, proposes solutions consistent with national policy, and closes by yielding remaining time (§ 8).

6.4 Points of Information After a GSL Speech

Once a speaker yields to questions, the Chair asks whether there are any points of information. Delegates raise a point of information to be recognized; the speaker answers each in turn until time runs out or the Chair moves on. Questions should relate directly to the speech's content, time used for Q&A comes out of the speaker's remaining time, and the speaker may decline to answer if time has expired.

6.5 Removing Yourself from the GSL

A delegate may withdraw before speaking, when the Chair calls for points or motions:

"The Delegate of [portfolio] would like to be removed from the General Speaker's List."

The Chair may deny removal if the delegate is already next on the list.

6.6 Keeping Participation Broad

If the same few delegates dominate the GSL while others stay silent, the Chair may encourage non-participants to add themselves, cap how often one delegation speaks per cycle, or move the committee into a moderated caucus to widen participation.

7. Moderated Caucuses

A moderated caucus is a focused, Chair-supervised discussion of a specific agenda subtopic, run on its own temporary Speaker's List. Participation is optional and the list has a fixed number of speaker slots.

7.1 Motioning

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to enter a moderated caucus for [total time] minutes with [number] speakers, each speaking for [time per speaker] seconds, on the topic of [subtopic]."

Element	Description	Example
Total time	Overall duration of the caucus	12 minutes
Number of speakers	Total delegates who will speak	18 speakers
Time per speaker	Total time ÷ number of speakers (60-second cap by default)	40 seconds
Topic	The specific subtopic under discussion	"Renewable energy infrastructure in developing nations"

Example: "The Delegate of France moves to enter a moderated caucus for 12 minutes with 18 speakers, each speaking for 40 seconds, on the topic of renewable energy infrastructure in developing nations."

7.2 Adoption and Building the Speaker's List

The motion is voted on (simple majority). If it passes, the Chair announces the terms and opens a dedicated Speaker's List:

"We will now take requests to be added to the moderated caucus Speaker's List. We will call out your country name in alphabetical order. Specify if you wish to speak."

The Chair calls alphabetically; delegates respond, "The Delegate of [portfolio] would like to be added to the Speaker's List," or decline. The list closes once the requested number of speakers is reached or no one else volunteers; if fewer delegates volunteer than requested, the caucus proceeds with the speakers it has. A portfolio may appear only once on a given moderated caucus's list, and there is no penalty for choosing not to speak.

7.3 Speaking During the Caucus

"The Delegate of [portfolio], you have been recognized. You have [X] seconds to address the topic of [subtopic]."

Speeches must stay on the assigned subtopic and the time limit is strictly enforced; standard time warnings apply. Because speaking times are short, there is typically no time left to yield to questions or comments — yielding to the Chair is standard unless time remains. If a delegate strays significantly off-topic, the Chair may warn them or interrupt.

7.4 Points of Information

By default, points of information are not permitted after moderated caucus speeches, since short speaking times make Q&A impractical. A motion to amend the ROP can change this for the rest of committee (§ 5, Motion 6).

7.5 How Many, and How Disruptive

Committees typically run about 3–4 moderated caucuses over the course of debate (a guideline, not a rule). Compared to unmoderated caucuses, adjournment, or recess, moderated caucuses are less disruptive: they run for shorter, fixed periods, keep a structured Speaker's List, and stay under the Chair's direct oversight (see the full disruption hierarchy in § 9.4).

8. Yielding

Every speech ends with a yield. At the end of a delegate's speech, the Chair asks how they would like to yield; if fewer than ten seconds remain, no yield is available and the Chair voids the remaining time.

8.1 Yield to Questions

"The Delegate of [portfolio] yields to questions."

Opens the floor to points of information from other delegates. Each question-and-answer exchange is deducted from the speaker's remaining time; the Chair decides how many questions fit. Only available after GSL speeches by default (§ 4.1, § 6.4), unless the ROP has been amended to extend it to moderated caucuses.

8.2 Yield to Comments

"The Delegate of [portfolio] yields to comments."

Lets other delegates make brief remarks on the speech; the original speaker does not respond. The Chair decides how many comments to take.

8.3 Yield to Another Delegate

"The Delegate of [portfolio] yields to the Delegate of [recipient's portfolio]."

Transfers the remaining time to a named delegate, who must accept it and use it immediately. At least thirty seconds must remain for this yield to be available, and a delegate may not yield to someone already on the current Speaker's List.

8.4 Yield to the Chair

"The Delegate of [portfolio] yields to the Chair."

Leaves the remaining time to the Chair's discretion — the default choice when little time remains or no other yield fits.

9. Unmoderated Caucuses

An unmoderated caucus suspends formal debate so delegates can talk freely, negotiate, build alliances, and work on documents without the Chair present. No points or motions can be raised and no points are scored during this time.

9.1 Motioning

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to suspend formal debate and enter an unmoderated caucus of [total time] minutes for the purpose of [reason]."

Examples:

- *Short, for discussion:* "The Delegate of Brazil moves to suspend formal debate for an unmoderated caucus of 10 minutes for the purpose of discussing potential subtopics for the next moderated caucus."
- *Long, for writing:* "The Delegate of Japan moves to suspend formal debate for an unmoderated caucus of 30 minutes for the purpose of writing draft resolutions."

The motion is voted on (simple majority). Once it passes, the Chair announces the time and purpose, the timer begins, and the Chair steps back while delegates disperse.

9.2 Short vs. Long Caucuses

	Short Caucus	Long Caucus (Drafting Session)
Duration	5–15 minutes	20–45+ minutes, or as needed
Typical timing	Between moderated caucuses, early-to-mid committee	After sufficient debate (roughly 3–4 mod./unmod. cycles)
Purpose	Discuss upcoming topics, form initial blocs, share ideas informally	Write Draft Resolutions, finalize working papers, solidify blocs
Outcome	Delegates return better prepared for the next caucus or GSL	Completed Draft Resolutions submitted to the Chair

9.3 What Happens During the Caucus

Permitted: speaking freely with any delegate, forming or joining blocs, lobbying, writing or editing working papers and DR clauses, exchanging contact information, sending informal chits, and discussing bloc strategy.

Not permitted / not scored: formal speeches or structured debate, raising points or motions (the Chair is not present to receive them), and submitting substantive chits (the Chair is unavailable). No points are awarded for any activity during the caucus itself — see § 10.9 for how lobbying and blocking are actually scored, through formal chits.

9.4 Ending the Caucus and Degree of Disruption

When time expires, the Chair returns and calls the committee back to order:

"The unmoderated caucus has concluded. We will now return to formal debate."

Delegates take their seats, and the Chair calls for points or motions; a GSL speech is required before the next caucus motion can be entertained (§ 6).

Because they remove the Chair's oversight entirely, can run long, and halt the Speaker's List, unmoderated caucuses rank among the most disruptive actions available to committee. The table below gives the full disruption hierarchy referenced throughout this document: more disruptive motions are generally addressed before less disruptive ones when several are on the floor, and disruptiveness rises with duration.

Disruption Level	Motions
Most disruptive	Adjournment, Recess, Unmoderated Caucus
Moderately disruptive	Close Debate, Table Debate
Less disruptive	Moderated Caucus, Introduce Draft Resolution
Least disruptive	Set Agenda, Extend Speaking Time, Amendments

10. Documentation

Every document a delegate submits demonstrates some mix of research, writing, and procedural skill, and is scored accordingly (§ 10.9).

10.1 Position Paper

A pre-committee submission, required from every delegate, laying out the portfolio's stance on the agenda.

- Contents: the portfolio's stance on the agenda; past national actions on the issue; past international actions (treaties signed, resolutions supported, etc.); proposed solutions consistent with national policy.
- Format: typically two pages; parenthetical in-text citations; a full reference list at the end, in MLA 8th edition format.
- Due before the formal session begins.
- Evaluated on research depth, policy alignment, clarity, and correct citation.

10.2 References

A record of every source consulted while preparing position papers, speeches, and other documents.

Document Type	Citation Requirement
Position Paper	Parenthetical citations plus a full MLA 8th-edition reference list
Speech	Verbal attribution; full references available on request
Press Release	All sources named in text
Draft Resolution / Working Paper	All sources named in text

10.3 Working Paper

An informal, unfinished draft used to float ideas, gather feedback, or record research before a Draft Resolution is written. It follows no strict format — typically just proposed solutions grouped by theme, sometimes with

rough preambulatory or operative language — and goes through no formal vote. It may be shared within a bloc or openly, and can later be developed into a Draft Resolution.

10.4 Draft Resolution (DR) and Resolution

A **Draft Resolution** is a proposed resolution written by delegates and awaiting introduction and a vote. A **Resolution** is a Draft Resolution that has passed by simple majority and become the committee's official position — once any single resolution passes, the remaining DRs are not voted on.

Authors actively wrote the resolution (minimum 1, typically max 2–3). **Signatories** support putting it to a vote and consideration, whether or not they agree with every clause.

Heading Format

Title: [free text, usually agenda-related]

Committee: [Committee Name]

Agenda: [full agenda as set at the start of committee]

Author(s): [full official country names]

Signatories: [full official country names of all supporting delegations]

The [Committee Name],

Preambulatory Clauses

Set out context, background, and justification for action. Each begins with an italicized preambulatory phrase and ends in a comma.

Common phrases: Affirming, Aware of, Bearing in mind, Believing, Contemplating, Deeply concerned, Emphasizing, Expecting, Fully alarmed, Guided by, Having adopted, Keeping in mind, Noting with regret, Observing, Reaffirming, Realizing, Recalling, Recognizing, Referring to, Seeking, Taking into account, Viewing with appreciation.

Operative Clauses

The actionable body of the resolution — numbered sequentially, each beginning with a bolded/underlined operative phrase, and ending in a semicolon except the final clause, which ends in a period.

Common phrases: Accepts, Adopts, Affirms, Approves, Authorizes, Calls upon, Condemns, Confirms, Considers, Declares, Deplores, Designates, Directs, Encourages, Endorses, Expresses its appreciation, Further recommends, Invites, Notes, Proclaims, Recommends, Regrets, Reminds, Requests, Resolves, Seeks, Supports, Suggests, Takes note of, Urges.

Content Requirements

To be accepted for presentation, a DR must offer clear, tangible, real-world solutions to the agenda, including: an enforcement mechanism (how it will be carried out), a funding source (how it will be paid for), and specific actions (exactly what will be done, by whom, and when).

Submission and Review

DRs are submitted to the Chair after the drafting period. The Chair reviews each for formatting and substantive completeness and typically accepts 2–3 for presentation to the committee.

10.5 Amendments

Amendments propose changes to a DR after it has been introduced.

Friendly Amendment

A minor change — grammar or spelling fixes, wording within a sub-clause, or a clarification that does not alter intent — that all authors agree to.

- Process: proposed to the authors; if all authors consent, it is implemented into the DR immediately. No committee vote is needed.

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to introduce a friendly amendment to Draft Resolution [number], [describe change]."

Unfriendly Amendment

A new clause, or a change to an existing clause, that the authors do not approve.

- Process: introduced to committee; put to a roll call vote; passes on a simple majority. If it fails, the original text stands.

"The Delegate of [portfolio] moves to introduce an unfriendly amendment to Draft Resolution [number], [describe addition or change]."

10.6 Press Release

A public statement summarizing the committee's deliberations, decisions, or stance — issued at the close of committee (alongside or instead of a resolution) or as directed by committee-specific rules. It covers what was discussed, key positions or agreements reached, and outcomes, and is written in an accessible, journalistic style that may quote delegates. All sources used must be named in the text.

10.7 Chits

A chit is a written, one-on-one message passed during formal session.

Formal Chit — Addressed to the Executive Board — a point of information or relevant blocking detail for the Chair's review. Must be marked "via EB"; the Chair considers all formal chits when allotting points.

Informal Chit — A personal or lobbying message to another delegate. Not reviewed by the EB and not scored.

10.8 Substantive Chit

A brief, informal document submitted directly to the Chair — distinct from a chit between delegates — when a delegate has more to contribute than their speaking time allowed.

- Use it: after a speech where time ran short; during a moderated caucus when not selected to speak; any time a delegate feels their position wasn't fully represented.
- Content: the portfolio's stance, urgent points not otherwise raised, or a contribution to a moderated caucus topic.
- The Chair scores it on content quality, relevance, and demonstrated knowledge.

10.9 How Documents Are Scored

Document	Skill Category
Position Paper	Research, Knowledge
References	Research
Substantive Chit	Knowledge, Delivery

Draft Resolution (authoring)	Resolution Writing
Working Paper	Resolution Writing
Formal Chits (blocking)	Lobbying

11. Voting Procedures

Voting is how the committee decides motions, amendments, Draft Resolutions, and other procedural matters. Every delegation's vote carries equal weight — except that the five permanent members can veto resolutions in the UN Security Council — and every threshold in this section is measured against delegates who are present and voting, not total committee membership.

11.1 How a Vote Is Conducted

Most substantive votes are taken by roll call: the Chair calls each portfolio alphabetically and each delegate responds verbally, creating an official record of how every delegation voted. Roll call is used for all three DR voting rounds, unfriendly amendments, and motions to close debate, adjourn, or reconsider.

"Delegate of [Portfolio 1]?" — "[Yes / No / Abstain / Yes with Rights / No with Rights]" "Delegate of [Portfolio 2]?" — "[...]"

Simpler procedural motions (entering formal debate, setting the agenda, entering a caucus, etc.) are typically decided by a show of placards rather than a full roll call, at the Chair's discretion.

11.2 Choosing Present vs. Present and Voting

Choose "Present" if...	Choose "Present and Voting" if...
You are undecided on the issues	You are confident in your portfolio's stance
You may want to abstain on controversial matters	You want to demonstrate strong commitment
Your nation traditionally avoids firm positions	Your nation has a clear, consistent policy
You want maximum flexibility during voting	You want to show leadership and decisiveness

11.3 Voting on Draft Resolutions

DRs are voted on individually, in presentation order, through up to three rounds. Voting stops the moment any resolution passes — the rest are not voted on.

Round 1 — Full Rights

Order	Response	Meaning
1st	Yes with Rights	In favor; wishes to explain the vote afterward
2nd	No with Rights	Opposed; wishes to explain the vote afterward
3rd	Yes	In favor, no explanation
4th	No	Opposed, no explanation
5th	Abstain	Neither for nor against (only available to "Present" delegations)

Round 2 — Second Rights

Identical structure to Round 1, giving delegations one more chance to explain or persuade before the final round.

Round 3 — Final Round (No Rights)

A simplified Yes / No / Abstain vote with no explanations and no speeches. If the resolution passes, it is adopted and the committee is successful; if it fails, the next accepted resolution (if any) goes through the same three rounds. If every presented resolution fails, the committee is unsuccessful.

11.4 Rights of Explanation ("With Rights")

Delegates who voted "Yes with Rights" or "No with Rights" in Round 1 or 2 get to explain their vote after everyone has voted. The Chair announces the preliminary result, then calls on No-with-Rights speakers first, followed by Yes-with-Rights speakers, each given a brief, fixed amount of time (30 seconds by default, extendable by motion). Rights are not available in Round 3.

Do	Don't
Explain your portfolio's reasoning	Attack other delegates personally
Reference national policy	Introduce entirely new arguments
Clarify your position on specific clauses	Exceed your allotted time
Acknowledge complexities of the issue	Re-deliver your full GSL speech

11.5 Majority Requirements

Simple Majority (more than 50% of those present and voting)

Decision Type	Examples
Procedural matters	Entering formal debate, setting the agenda, caucuses, amending the Speaker's List, extending speaking time
Draft Resolutions	Adopting a resolution, any round
Unfriendly amendments	Adding or changing a clause against the authors' wishes
ROP amendments	Changing a standing rule of procedure

Example: of 20 delegates present and voting — 11 Yes, 8 No, 1 Abstain → passes (11 of 19 non-abstaining votes is a majority).

Special Majority (two-thirds or more)

Decision Type	Examples
Close debate	Moving directly to voting procedure
Adjourn	Ending the session permanently
Reconsider	Revoting on a previously decided matter

Example: of 18 delegates present and voting, at least 12 Yes votes are needed ($12/18 = 66.7\%$); 11 Yes, 7 No fails (61.1%, below two-thirds).

11.6 Voting on Amendments

Friendly: no committee vote — submitted to the authors, and implemented immediately if all consent.

Unfriendly: a roll call vote, requiring a simple majority; if it fails, the DR's original text stands unchanged.

11.7 Majority Reference Table

Motion / Action	Majority Required
Enter Formal Debate	Simple
Set Agenda	Simple
Suspend Debate (Unmoderated Caucus)	Simple
Enter Moderated Caucus	Simple
Introduce Draft Resolution	Simple
Amend Rules of Procedure	Simple
Extend Speaking Time	Simple
Friendly Amendment	None (author approval only)
Unfriendly Amendment	Simple
Close Debate	Special (2/3)
Adjourn Session	Special (2/3)
Reconsider	Special (2/3)

11.8 After Voting

If a resolution passes: the Chair announces success, remaining DRs are not voted on, formal debate is suspended, and the committee is adjourned — brief closing remarks may follow at the Chair's discretion.

If all resolutions fail: the Chair announces that the committee has been unsuccessful; formal debate is suspended and the committee is adjourned all the same.

After any other vote: the Chair announces the count in favor, opposed, and abstaining, then resumes normal debate by asking, "Are there any points or motions on the floor?"

12. Glossary

Quick-reference definitions. For full procedure and scripts, see the section indicated.

Term	Quick Definition
Adjournment	Permanent end of the committee session. § 5, § 11.8
Agenda	The problem the committee addresses, official once set by motion. § 1.2, § 2.1
Bloc / Blocking	An informal group of delegates collaborating on documents; recruiting members is called blocking. § 9.3, § 10.9
Chit (Formal / Informal)	A one-on-one written message during formal session. § 10.7
Degree of Disruption	How much a motion interrupts committee flow; used to prioritize competing motions. § 9.4
Draft Resolution / Resolution	A proposed solution document, or one that has passed. § 10.4
Flow of Committee	The required order of proceedings. § 2
GSL (General Speaker's List)	The committee's continuous default Speaker's List. § 6
Lobbying	Persuading other delegates to support a motion or resolution. § 9.3
Motion	A formal request to the Chair about debate flow. § 5
Out of Order	A point, motion, or ruling that violates procedure or timing.
Point	A formal question or request to the Chair. § 4
Position Paper	A pre-committee submission stating a portfolio's stance. § 10.1
Quorum	Minimum attendance for committee to act. § 1.2
Roll Call Vote	A vote taken by calling delegates alphabetically. § 11.1
Simple / Special Majority	More than 50%, or two-thirds or more, of those present and voting. § 11.5
Speaker's List	The order in which delegates speak. § 6, § 7.2
Substantive Chit	A brief document submitted to the Chair to make up for lost speaking time. § 10.8
Working Paper	An informal draft of ideas, a precursor to a Draft Resolution. § 10.3
Yield	How a delegate disposes of remaining speech time. § 8